AURELIA · FEEDBACK GROUP FG-2026-01 · PROJECT MANAGER PLAYBOOK · 11 NOVEMBER 2026

Eight weeks to find out whether Aurelia gets people better

For the project manager who will recruit up to 30 people with different wellness problems and guide them every day, using Aurelia, from the problem to the healthy range. What each milestone is for, what you do, how you know it is passed, and where the admin shows it.



A win: “bad sleep → good sleep” means moving into the healthy band of their own questionnaire, not only a better score. Illustration, not data.

30 people · six issues | 8 weeks + 3 to prepare | Source of truth: admin → Experimentation

AI analysis · Based on Claude self-analysis and deep research

1. Why this matters

This is the product-market-fit test for Aurelia. Everything built so far rests on one promise: that a person with a common wellness problem can describe it in a sentence and get better with sessions made for them. Until real people with real problems get better, that promise is a design. In eight weeks we will know whether it holds, for whom, and what has to change.

People solve their issue

They move from the problem range into the healthy range of their own questionnaire. That is a win, and it is what the study is for.

They keep using it

Three or more sessions a week without being pushed harder each week. An effect without use is noise; use without effect is a finding.

They would miss it

At least 40% would be “very disappointed” to lose Aurelia: the usual product-market-fit bar.

The hypothesis. People with a common wellness problem who use Aurelia three or more times a week, with light daily guidance, move from the problem range into the healthy range of their own issue within eight weeks, and would be very disappointed to lose it. **What would disprove it:** people do not use it even with your guidance, or they use it and do not change, or they change and would not miss it.

2. Your role

You are the guide, Aurelia does the work

Your job is to keep people playing, listening and honest about how they feel. The sessions, the chapters and the changes come from Aurelia. When you are tempted to give advice, ask a question instead and pass what you heard to the product team.

You are the study's memory

Every contact goes in the coaching log the same day. If it is not in the admin, it did not happen, and nobody can learn from it.

You are not a clinician

You never interpret a score to a participant, never suggest stopping a treatment, and never handle a crisis alone. Safety goes to the study lead the same day.

3. Six issues, and what a win means for each

Each person joins one cohort: the goal they choose in Aurelia's onboarding, and one validated questionnaire for it. Recruit to these numbers.

COHORT	APP GOAL	THEIR QUESTIONNAIRE	HEALTHY BAND (A WIN)	MEANINGFUL CHANGE	PEOPLE
Bad sleep → good sleep	Sleep better	Insomnia Severity Index (ISI), 0–28	7 or less: no insomnia	6 points lower	6
Anxious → calm	Feel calmer	GAD-7, 0–21	4 or less: minimal	4 points lower	6

COHORT	APP GOAL	THEIR QUESTIONNAIRE	HEALTHY BAND (A WIN)	MEANINGFUL CHANGE	PEOPLE
Mental fog → clarity	Clear my mind	PROMIS Cognitive Function (T-score)	45 or more: within normal	5 points higher	5
Low energy → energy	More energy	PROMIS Fatigue (T-score)	54 or less: within normal	5 points lower	5
Distracted → focused	Focus	PROMIS Cognitive Function (T-score)	45 or more: within normal	5 points higher	4
Stressed body → regulated	Regulate my body	Perceived Stress Scale (PSS-10), 0–40	13 or less: low stress	4 points lower	4

Everyone also answers WHO-5 (well-being, 0–100) every two weeks: a gain of 10 points is meaningful, and 28 or below is a cue for a person to follow up. A clinical advisor confirms the thresholds before week 0.

4. The eleven weeks at a glance



Questionnaires: WHO-5 at weeks 0, 2, 4, 6 and 8; the cohort measure and PHQ-9 at weeks 0, 4 and 8; interviews at weeks 0, 4 and 8. A check-in after every session.

5. The six milestones

Each milestone has a gate: the lines that say it is passed. The admin computes the same gates in **Version 2 → Milestones**, so you never have to work them out by hand.

M0 Set up and recruit

Three weeks before week 0

Thirty people across six issues, consented and screened, with the study tools ready.

YOU

- Recruit 4–6 people per issue (table in section 3), from outside the team and outside anyone's friends.
- Screen with PHQ-9 and the exclusion list; anyone excluded is offered support resources, not dropped silently.
- Take informed consent; give each person a pseudonymous id (P01–P30) and keep the name key outside every tool.
- Book every baseline call and agree each person's daily time (for sleep, the evening).

THE PRODUCT TEAM

- Accounts that stay signed in, study enrolment, the questionnaire screens and the safety alert (protocol section 10).
- A clinical advisor and an ethics review confirm the measures and the safety process.

GATE: PASSED WHEN

☐ 30 enrolled, every cohort filled

☐ Ethics review and clinical advisor: confirmed by a person

If it is not: Do not start with fewer than 24. Extend recruitment a week rather than start a cohort with one person.

See it in admin →

M1 Baseline and first session

Week 0

Everyone measured before they start, and playing within two days.

YOU

- Collect WHO-5, the cohort measure and PHQ-9 before the first session. A baseline after use is not a baseline.
- Interview 1 (30 minutes): what the problem is like, what they have tried, what "solved" would mean to them, in their words.
- Sit with each person (call or in person) for their first session: onboarding, the first sentence, the first play.
- Write their goal sentence in the coaching log: it is what you will measure the next eight weeks against.

THE PRODUCT TEAM

- Watches the first sessions for blockers and fixes the ones that stop people playing.

GATE: PASSED WHEN

☐ Baseline WHO-5 and cohort measure: 100%

☐ Played a first session in week 1: 90% or more

If it is not: Anyone without a baseline does not count for outcomes. Collect it before they play again.

See it in admin →

M2 Build the habit

Weeks 1–2

A daily rhythm: three or more sessions a week, a check-in after each.

YOU

- One short message a day at each person's agreed time (templates in section 6). Ask, do not lecture.
- Anyone under two sessions in a week gets a call: what got in the way, and one small change (shorter, earlier, a different voice).
- Log every contact in the participant's coaching log, the same day.
- Collect WHO-5 at the end of week 2.

THE PRODUCT TEAM

- A weekly 30-minute review with you: the top three blockers, ranked by how many people they hit.

GATE: PASSED WHEN

☐ 3+ sessions in both weeks 1 and 2: 70% or more

☐ WHO-5 week 2 answered: 85% or more

If it is not: Below 70% the study measures who had time, not whether Aurelia helps. Fix the blocker before week 3, even if it is not in the app.

See it in admin →

M3 Midpoint read, first iteration

Weeks 3–4

Read what is and is not working, and ship one change for the second half.

YOU

- Week 4: WHO-5, cohort measure, PHQ-9 and interview 2 with everyone.
- Bring the top three findings to the product team, each with the participants it affects and their own words.
- When the change ships, explain it to participants in one message: what changed and why.

THE PRODUCT TEAM

- Ships one change, as a new design version on staging first, by the start of week 5.
- Does not change the questionnaires or the timing: the measures must stay comparable.

GATE: PASSED WHEN

☐ Still enrolled: 85% or more

☐ Due questionnaires collected: 85% or more

☐ Iteration shipped to the group: confirmed by the product team

If it is not: Interim outcome figures are shown but not judged. A disappointing week 4 is information for the iteration, not a verdict.

See it in admin →

M4 Second half, second iteration

Weeks 5–7

Measure whether the change helped, and make one more adjustment if needed.

YOU

- Keep the daily rhythm. People who are winning need less; people who are stuck need a call a week.
- Collect WHO-5 at week 6.
- Follow up every safety alert the same day, and write down what you did.

THE PRODUCT TEAM

- Compares weeks 5–7 with weeks 1–4 for the people the change was for.
- A second change only if the first did not help, again on staging first.

GATE: PASSED WHEN

☐ Adherent people (3+ sessions in 60% of weeks): 60% or more

☐ Every safety alert followed up the same day: confirmed by the study lead

If it is not: If adherence falls in the second half, ask why in a call before changing anything else.

See it in admin →

M5

Final read and decision

Weeks 8–9

The pass lines decide: go, iterate or pivot.

YOU

- Week 8: WHO-5, cohort measure, PHQ-9, the value question and interview 3.
- Write one story per cohort: where the person started, what changed, in their words, with their consent.
- Present the result in week 9 against the pass lines set before week 0.

THE PRODUCT TEAM

- Prepares the decision: what scales, what changes, what stops.

GATE: PASSED WHEN

- ☐ Well-being improves: 50% gain 10+ WHO-5 points
- ☐ Their own issue improves: 40% reach the meaningful change
- ☐ People stay: 70% still enrolled
- ☐ Data to judge: 85% collected
- ☐ Would miss it: 40% "very disappointed"

If it is not: The lines were fixed before week 0. Moving them after reading the data turns the study into a story.

See it in admin →

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6. Your day and your week

A day

08:30

Open This week

Calls first, then anyone not reached for two days, then missed questionnaires.

Open →

09:00–11:00

Calls and follow-ups

Safety alerts the same day, always first. Then anyone stuck.

A week

Monday Milestones tab: which gate is next, and is it on track?

Wednesday Call everyone under two sessions last week.

Friday 30 minutes with the product team: the top three findings, with who they affect.

Every other week WHO-5 goes out; chase it within 48 hours.

The daily message, by issue

Each person's time

One message

Short, a question, about their own goal. Template below.

Same day

Log it

Coaching log on their page: what they said, how they feel 1–5, the next step.

Open →

16:30

Five-minute look

Wins and Engagement: who moved, who went quiet.

Open →

Bad sleep	*"Morning! How did last night go: roughly how long to fall asleep, and did you wake up?"*
Anxious	*"How is your day feeling, 1 to 5? Did the session before your meeting help, or not really?"*
Mental fog	*"Did you get a clear hour today? What did you play before it?"*
Low energy	*"How was your energy this afternoon compared with yesterday?"*
Distracted	*"How long did your longest focused stretch last today?"*
Stressed body	*"Where do you feel it today? Did the breathing chapter change anything?"*

One question, about their own goal, at the time they chose. Never “did you do your session?”.

When someone goes quiet

Missed a day

Your usual message; no comment on the miss.

Not reached for 2 days

They appear in This week. A second message, then a short call.

Under 2 sessions in a week

A call: what got in the way, and one small change.

Two questionnaires missed

A call, and offer to fill it in together.

Any sign of crisis or harm

Stop coaching. Crisis resources now, and the study lead the same day. Never handle it alone.

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7. Testing and iterating with the product team

The study is not only a measurement; it is how the product gets better while people use it. One loop, every week, and one significant change per half so its effect can be read.

1 · Hear

Coaching log, interviews, check-ins.

2 · Rank

How many people it hits × how much it stops them.

3 · Change

One change, as a new version on staging first.

4 · Explain

Tell participants what changed and why.

5 · Measure

Same measures, before and after the change.

Rules for a change

- At most one significant change in each half (M3, then M4 if needed).
- Staging first, as a new design version, then the group.
- The questionnaires and their timing never change.
- Every change is written down with the date it reached the group.

What a good finding looks like

“Four of six in the sleep cohort stop the session halfway because the voice is too fast (P02, P04, P05, P06; coaching log 3–5 Nov).” Who, how many, their words, where it is written.

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8. The admin is the source of truth

Everything you need to run and judge the study is in **admin → Experimentation**. If a question is not answered there, tell the product team; that is a gap in the tool, not something to keep in a spreadsheet.

YOUR QUESTION	WHERE	
Where are we, and is the next gate on track?	**Version 2 → Milestones**	Open →
What do I do today?	**Version 2 → This week**	Open →
Who has solved their issue?	**Version 2 → Wins**	Open →
Is use going with change?	**Version 2 → Engagement**	Open →
How is this one person doing?	**Participant page: measures, sessions, coaching log**	Open →
Are the pass lines on track?	**Version 1 → Overview**	Open →
Is any data missing?	**Version 1 → Data & safety**	Open →
What exactly do we collect, and when?	**Version 1 → What we collect**	Open →

Today the admin shows sample data, generated by the same rules the real data will use. The coaching log saves in your browser until the backend exists. Both are listed in the protocol as things to build before week 0.

9. Rules that never bend

Privacy

- Pseudonymous ids (P01–P30) everywhere; names stay outside every tool.
- No names or contact details in the coaching log.
- Journal and wearable data only with their own consent.

Safety

- PHQ-9 item 9 above zero, WHO-5 of 28 or below, or any report of harm: the study lead calls the same day.
- Crisis resources first, always.
- Aurelia is not a treatment and never replaces one.

Honesty

- Pass lines are fixed before week 0.
- People who leave stay in the count.
- No claim that Aurelia caused a change: there is no control group.

10. The decision at week 9

Go

Most pass lines met, including "their own issue improves" and "would miss it".

Plan a controlled trial and open a wider beta for the cohorts that won.

Iterate

People use it and stay, but outcomes are short of the lines.

A second eight-week cycle on the same design, with the changes the data points to.

Pivot

People do not use it even with daily guidance, or would not miss it.

Stop and rethink the core loop before more building.

11. Before week 0

READY?	WHAT	WHO
☐	Design, pass lines and this playbook approved	Product owner, Eugene
☐	Clinical advisor and ethics review; questionnaire licences (ISI, PSS-10)	Product owner
☐	Accounts that stay signed in; study enrolment and consent in the app	Product team
☐	Questionnaire screens with reminders; the safety alert to the study lead	Product team
☐	The admin on real data, including the coaching log	Product team
☐	30 people recruited, screened and consented; baseline calls booked	You

Companion to the study protocol (`docs/reviews/Aurelia-Feedback-Group-Study-2026-11-10.pdf`). The milestones are computed in admin by `src/admin/data/study.ts` ; this document is generated by `scripts/guides/pm_playbook.py` . AI analysis by Claude, based on its own analysis of the app and deep research.